

OGNJEN BADIVUK

Backend / Application Engineer · PHP · Python · Data Pipelines · Laravel
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend and Application Engineer with 3+ years of professional experience building and maintaining high-reliability data scraping systems, RESTful API integrations, and ETL pipelines at scale. Proficient in PHP (Laravel) and Python, with a strong track record of improving data quality, reducing pipeline failures, and owning complex features end-to-end at Better Collective — a global leader in sports betting media. Currently advancing the scraping architecture with a focus on robustness, observability, and maintainability. M.Sc. candidate in Software and Data Engineering.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	PHP, Python, SQL (MySQL)
Frameworks	Laravel, PHPUnit, pytest, unittest.mock
Tools	Git, REST APIs, AWS, CodeShip (CI/CD), Puppeteer
Concepts	Web Scraping, ETL / Data Pipelines, OOP, Decorator Pattern, Data Normalization, Unit Testing, TDD, Agile / Scrum
Databases	MySQL — query optimisation, schema design, migrations

EXPERIENCE

Better Collective | Full Stack Engineer

Jan 2026 – Present

- ▶ Architect and lead improvements to a large-scale PHP/Python scraping framework, enhancing system robustness, error handling, and long-term maintainability.
- ▶ Design and implement data monitoring and validation mechanisms that enforce data quality and consistency across multiple affiliate tracking integrations.
- ▶ Drive end-to-end ownership of complex features — from technical design and implementation through deployment and post-release maintenance.
- ▶ Optimise existing data pipeline components for performance, scalability, and fault tolerance — the system executes 17,000+ automated scraping jobs daily, completing the full run in under 3 hours and persisting 40,000+ records to the database per cycle.
- ▶ Collaborate cross-functionally with data, product, and platform teams to deliver reliable, production-grade data pipelines.

Better Collective | Junior Full Stack Engineer

Oct 2022 – Dec

2025

- ▶ Maintained and developed 200+ PHP and Python scraping scripts within a modular, tree-based framework (decorator pattern, Recipe classes), ensuring 100% successful data capture across all integrated affiliate sources.
- ▶ Engineered RESTful API integrations with affiliate/partner tracking platforms, implementing payout parsing, commission calculation, and conversion tracking logic.
- ▶ Improved data extraction reliability by debugging and extending core decorator classes (ConvertXmlToJson, ConvertCsvToJson), resolving edge-case failures and expanding unit test coverage.
- ▶ Authored Laravel database migrations following strict codebase conventions, extending the schema with nullable decimal commission columns for new metrics tracking.
- ▶ Implemented regex-based affiliate identifier parsing (pipe-delimited preg_match patterns) to support multi-parameter affiliate tracking across networks.
- ▶ Wrote and refactored unit tests using pytest and unittest.mock, ensuring correctness and long-term maintainability of decorator classes.
- ▶ Supported CI/CD pipeline stability via CodeShip and AWS, contributing to reliable deployment workflows.

Sep 2022

- Contributed to software development projects in a professional team environment, applying OOP principles and collaborating with senior engineers to deliver working software solutions.

EDUCATION

Master of Software and Data Engineering · Singidunum University · 2023 – Present (*In Progress*)

Bachelor of Software and Data Engineering · Singidunum University · 2019 – 2023

CERTIFICATIONS & COURSES

IBM Academic Initiative Essentials of Rational Software Architect

Oracle Academy Database Design and Programming with SQL

Udemy Learn PHP Programming From Scratch

Keywords: PHP Laravel Python MySQL REST API web scraping ETL data pipeline data quality data engineering backend engineer application engineer GA AWS CodeShip CI/CD unit testing pytest OOP decorator pattern Agile Scrum